

Chapter 29

Toward Abstraction: The Modernist Revolution, 1904–1914

Learning Objectives

1. Describe how the art made in the late 1940s and early 1950s reflects the attitude held by many following the devastation of World War II, that life could no longer be controlled or understood.
2. Discuss how art also was impacted by the unprecedented prosperity and consumerism of post-World War II America and Europe as well as by the technological developments brought on by the Cold War and Space Race.
3. Discuss the impact on art of the social revolution that challenged the status quo beginning in 1950s and gained momentum in the 1960s and 1970s.
4. Explain why Minimal Art became such an iconic movement that artists felt compelled to react to and against, in part giving rise to the term Postminimal Art and calling the 1970s the pluralistic decade.
5. Explain why many scholars describe the Dada artist Marcel Duchamp as a major force in the art of the second half of the twentieth century.

Postwar Art in Europe and the Americas

- The devastation of World War II led to the deaths of over 30 million people and displacement for yet 40 million more.
- Churchill described Europe as "a breeding ground of pestilence and hate."

Figural Responses and *Art Informel* in Europe (1 of 2)

- Most immediately postwar art involved figural or abstracted works attempting to cope with the horrors of war.
- Francis Bacon's *Head Surrounded by Sides of Beef* portrays Pope Innocent X as an anguished and insubstantial man.
 - It was directly inspired by Diego Velázquez's work of the same subject.



Francis Bacon HEAD SURROUNDED BY SIDES OF BEEF

1954. Oil on canvas, 50-3/4" x 48" (129 x 122 cm).

The Art Institute of Chicago. Harriott A. Fox Fund (1956.1201). © The Estate of Francis Bacon. All rights reserved.
DACS, London/ARS, NY 2016. Photo © The Art Institute of Chicago.

Figural Responses and *Art Informel* in Europe (2 of 2)

- *Art informel* (*tachisme*) was a distinct movement born of the sentiment that art should comprise of simple, honest marks to express postwar humanity.
- Wols's *Painting* represents a disease-ridden and violent world through its semiabstracted form that resembles a cell or bacterial growth.



Wols (Wolfgang Schulze) PAINTING

1944–1945. Oil on canvas, 31-7/8" × 32" (81 × 81.1 cm).

Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of D. and J. de Menil Fund (29.1956). © 2016 Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York/ADAGP, Paris. © 2016. Digital Image, The Museum of Modern Art/Scala, Florence.

Experiments in Latin America

- Wifredo Lam brought issues of heritage, identity, and discovery to his art in Cuba.
 - *Zambezia, Zambzia* recalls European Modernism but represents a *santería* ritual.
- Torres-García's *Abstract Art in Five Tones and Complementaries* fuses Inca imagery and mason patterns.



Wifredo Lam ZAMBEZIA, ZAMBEZIA

1950. Oil on canvas, 49-3/8" x 43-5/8" (125 x 110 cm).

Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum, New York. Gift, Mr. Joseph Cantor, 1974 (74.2095).

© 2016 Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York/ADAGP, Paris. The Solomon R. Guggenheim Foundation/Art Resource, NY.



Joaquín Torres-García ABSTRACT ART IN FIVE TONES AND COMPLEMENTARIES
1943. Oil on board mounted on panel, 20-1/2" x 26-5/8" (52.1 x 67 cm).
Albright Knox Art Gallery, Buffalo, NY. Gift of Mr. and Mrs. Armand J. Castellani, 1979. Art Resource, NY.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(1 of 12)

- The United States did not experience quite as much trauma as did Europe.
- In its recovery, New York was able to "steal the idea of Modern art," as art historian Serge Guilbault asserts.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(2 of 12)

- The Center Shifts to New York
 - Displaced artists including Breton, Dalí, Léger, Mondrian, and Ernst found a new home in New York.
 - Abstract Expressionism describes a wide range of artists who worked in the city and wished to express their profound social alienation following the war.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(3 of 12)

- The Center Shifts to New York
 - **Formalist** critic Greenberg argued that the best paintings did not reference the outside world but rather told their own internal narrative.
 - Abstract Expressionism became divided in what critics called **Action painting** and Color Field painting, although the artists themselves believed these designations were simplistic.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(4 of 12)

- The Formative Phase
 - The Armenian Arshile Gorky created works honoring memories of the people and places he lost in his life.
 - *Garden in Sochi* contains forms referring to a garden featuring a wishing rock and a "Holy Tree."



Arshile Gorky GARDEN IN SOCHI
c. 1943. Oil on canvas, 31" x 39" (78.7 x 99.1 cm).
Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the Lillie P. Bliss Bequest (492.1969). © 2016 The Arshile Gorky Foundation/The Artists
Rights Society (ARS), New York. © 2016. Digital image, The Museum of Modern Art, New York/Scala, Florence.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(5 of 12)

- Jackson Pollock and Action Painting
 - Influenced by the works of Jung, Pollock created works on unprepared canvases on the floor by throwing, dripping, and dribbling paint in abstract, overlapping lines.
 - *Autumn Rhythm (Number 30)* was recorded on film and shows Pollock's transformation of the idea of painting itself.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(6 of 12)

- Jackson Pollock and Action Painting
 - The scale of *Autumn Rhythm* is about 9 feet tall by 17 feet wide.
 - Pollock also drew inspiration from improvisational jazz music and Native American art.



Jackson Pollock AUTUMN RHYTHM (NUMBER 30)
1950, Oil on canvas, 8'9" x 17'3" (2.66 x 5.25 m).

Metropolitan Museum of Art, New York. George A. Hearn Fund, 1957 (57.92). © 2016 The Pollock-Krasner Foundation/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York. © 2016. Image copyright The Metropolitan Museum of Art, New York/Art Resource/Scala, Florence.



Rudolph Burckhardt JACKSON POLLOCK PAINTING IN EAST HAMPTON, LONG ISLAND
1950. © 2016 Estate of Rudy Burckhardt/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York. © Rudolph
Burckhardt/Sygma/Corbis.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(7 of 12)

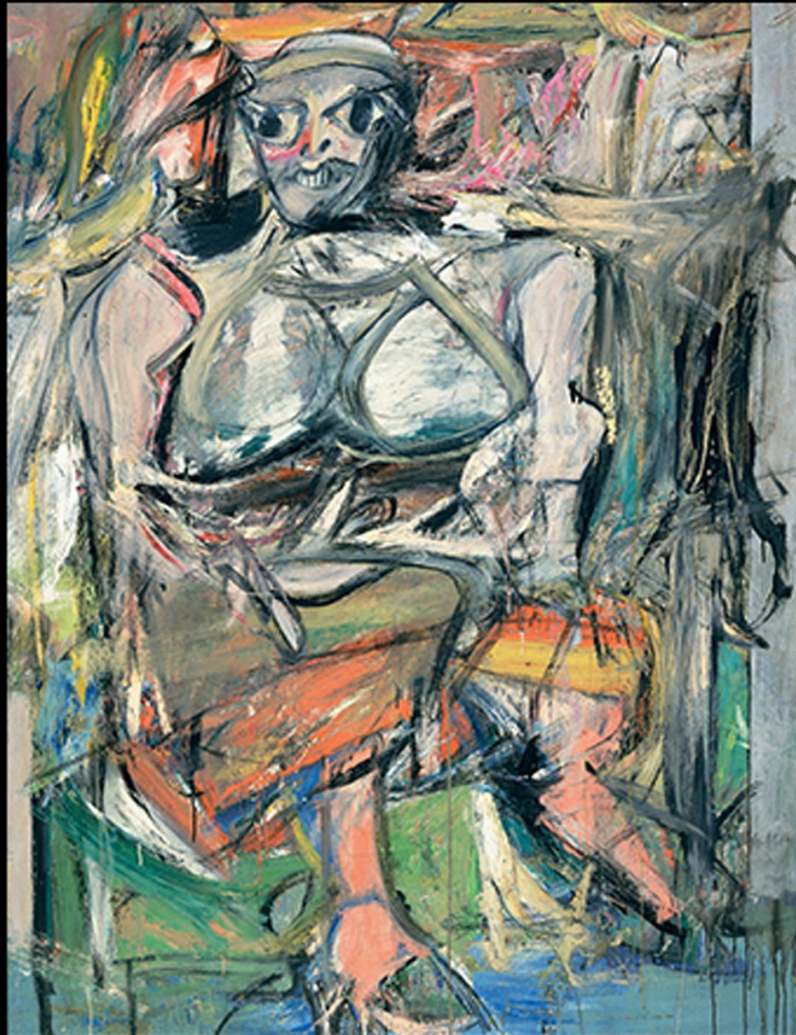
- Krasner, de Kooning, Mitchell, Riopelle, and Frankenthaler
 - Lee Krasner took over Pollock's art studio and created large gestural paintings such as *The Seasons*.
 - *Woman I* by Willem de Kooning was a move away from the artist's usual style of abstraction.
 - The grotesque, passionate portrait was scraped and repainted about 200 times.



Lee Krasner THE SEASONS

1957. Oil on canvas, 7'8-3/4" x 16'11-3/4" (2.36 x 5.18 m).

Whitney Museum of American Art, New York. Purchased with funds from Frances and Sydney Lewis (by exchange), the Mrs. Percy Uris Purchase Fund, and the Painting and Sculpture Committee (87.7). © 2016 Pollock-Krasner Foundation/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York.



Willem de Kooning WOMAN I
1950–1952. Oil on canvas, 75-7/8" × 58" (192.7 × 147.3 cm).
Museum of Modern Art, New York. © 2016. Digital image, The Museum of Modern Art, New York/Scala, Florence. ©
2016 The Willem de Kooning Foundation/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(8 of 12)

- Krasner, de Kooning, Mitchell, Riopelle, and Frankenthaler
 - A second generation of painters in this style emerged during the 1950s, including Joan Mitchell.
 - *Ladybug* captured energetic but controlled rhythms.



Joan Mitchell LADYBUG
1957. Oil on canvas, 6'-7/8" x 9' (1.98 x 2.74 m).
Museum of Modern Art, New York. © Estate of Joan Mitchell. Purchase (385.1961).
© Estate of Joan Mitchell © 2016. Digital image, The Museum of Modern Art, New York/Scala, Florence.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(9 of 12)

- Krasner, de Kooning, Mitchell, Riopelle, and Frankenthaler
 - In Canada, Jean-Paul Riopelle experimented with squeezing paint directly on the canvas before spreading it, as seen in *Knight Watch*.



Jean-Paul Riopelle KNIGHT WATCH
1953. Oil on canvas, 38" x 76-5/8" (96.6 x 194.8 cm).
National Gallery of Canada, Ottawa, Ontario. © 2016 Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York/SODRAC, Montreal.
National Gallery of Canada.

Abstract Expressionism in New York (10 of 12)

- Krasner, de Kooning, Mitchell, Riopelle, and Frankenthaler
 - Helen Frankenthaler sought to create more lyrical versions of action paintings with thinner washes of paint that soaked the canvas.
 - *Mountains and Sea* was inspired by the coast of Nova Scotia where the artist frequently went to sketch.



Helen Frankenthaler MOUNTAINS AND SEA

1952. Oil and charcoal on canvas, 7'2-3/4" x 9'8-1/4" (2.2 x 2.95 m).

Helen Frankenthaler Foundation, Inc., on loan to the National Gallery of Art, Washington, DC. Image courtesy of the National Gallery of Art, Washington. © 2016 Helen Frankenthaler Foundation, Inc./Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(11 of 12)

- Color Field Painting and Sculpture
 - Mark Rothko had little formal training but created paintings such as *Untitled (Rothko Number 5068.49)* as "ideas" with colors bleeding into one another in shapes that sought to evoke meditation.
 - Barnett Newman created *Vir Heroicus Sublimis*, a broad red field without any form that is only interrupted by zips of other colors.



Mark Rothko UNTITLED (ROTHKO NUMBER 5068.49)

1949. Oil on canvas, 6'9- $\frac{3}{8}$ " x 5'6- $\frac{3}{8}$ " (2.1 x 1.4 m).

National Gallery of Art, Washington, DC. © 1998 Kate Rothko Prizel & Christopher Rothko/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York. Image courtesy the National Gallery of Art, Washington.



Barnett Newman VIR HEROICUS SUBLIMIS
1950–1951. Oil on canvas, 95-3/8" x 213-1/4" (242 x 541.7 cm).
Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Mr. and Mrs. Ben Heller. © 2016 The Barnett Newman Foundation, New York /Artists Rights Society
(ARS), New York. The Museum of Modern Art. © 2009 Digital Image, The Museum of Modern Art, New York/Scala, Florence.

Abstract Expressionism in New York

(12 of 12)

- Color Field Painting and Sculpture
 - David Smith became a sculptor after learning to weld and rivet at an automobile plant.
 - His *Cubi* series featured stainless-steel sheets with surfaces that showed the gestural marks of the artist's tools.
 - Forms were vaguely anthropomorphic, becoming more organic at a closer range.

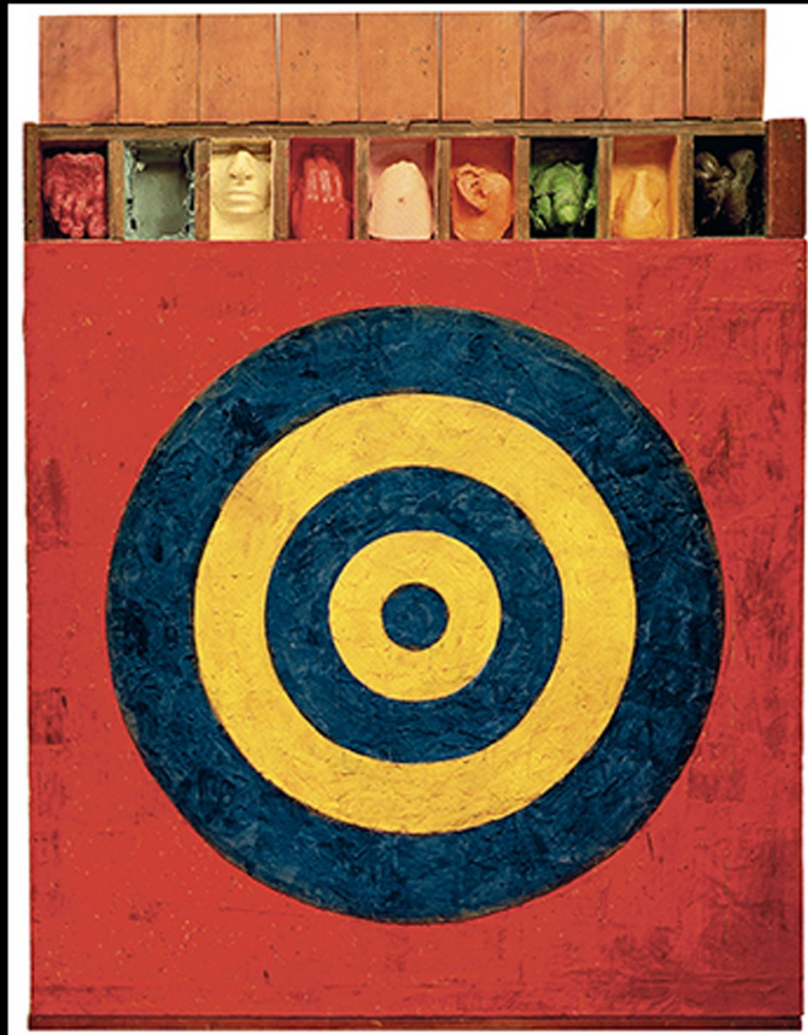


David Smith CUBI

Cubi series shown installed at Bolton Landing, New York, in 1965.

Cubi XVIII (left), 1964. Stainless steel, 9'8" (2.94 m). Museum of Fine Arts, Boston. *Cubi XVII* (center), 1963. Stainless steel, 9'2" (2.79 m). Dallas Museum of Fine Arts. *Cubi XIX* (right), 1964. Stainless steel, 9'5-3/8" (2.88 m). Tate, London.

Art © Estate of David Smith/Licensed by VAGA, New York, NY.



Jasper Johns TARGET WITH PLASTER CASTS

1955. Encaustic and collage on canvas with objects, 51" x 44" (129.5 x 111.8 cm). Collection Mr. and Mrs. Leo Castelli. Courtesy Castelli Gallery, Photo: Rudolph Burckhardt. Art © Jasper Johns/Licensed by VAGA, New York, NY.

The World since the 1950s

- The political and economic shifts brought by the end of World War II meant that the U.S. and Soviet Union emerged as the world's powerful nations; this led to the Cold War.
 - The strategy of mutually assured destruction was intended to deter nuclear war.
- The United Nations' efforts to maintain global peace have proven inadequate.
- Terrorist attacks on the World Trade Center and Pentagon on September 11, 2001 only exacerbated racial, ethnic, and religious conflicts.

The History of Art since the 1950s

- Fundamental questions about art arose.
 - What is art?
 - Do works need to be objects or can they be ideas?
 - Is it a combination of idea and object?
- Art that causes us to question our own morality is rarely easy to look at, yet it engages us in necessary conversation.

The Expanding Art World

- Artists acknowledged the fragmentation, relativism, and messy relation of art to popular culture through assemblage and collage.
- Pop artists and photographers made new aspects of art and advertisement visible.

Finding New Forms (1 of 3)

- A new artistic path developed that combined disparate elements to construct a work of art.
- Louise Nevelson developed an Analytic Cubist-inspired style, collecting discarded packing boxes to arrange objects painted in matte black.
 - *Sky Cathedral* is an example.



Louise Nevelson SKY CATHEDRAL

1958. Assemblage of wood construction painted black,
11'3-1/2" x 10'-1/4" x 18" (3.44 x 3.05 x 0.46 m).

The Museum of Modern Art, New York. © 2016 Estate of Louise Nevelson/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York. © 2016. Digital image, The Museum of Modern Art, New York/Art Resource/Scala, Florence.

Finding New Forms (2 of 3)

- Rauschenberg, Cage, and Black Mountain College
 - Robert Rauschenberg developed **combines** of painting, collage, and sculpture in non-traditional material.
 - *Canyon* includes a stuffed eagle and suspended old pillow in its rich disorder.
 - His work was exhibited in the Museum of Modern Art's "The Art of Assemblage" in 1961, as one of two American artists.



Robert Rauschenberg CANYON

1959. Oil, pencil, paper, metal, photograph, fabric, wood on canvas, plus buttons, mirror, stuffed eagle, pillow tied with cord, and paint tube, 81-3/4" x 70" x 24" (2.08 x 1.78 x 0.61 m). Museum of Modern Art, NY. Gift of the family of Ileana Sonnabend. Art © Robert Rauschenberg Foundation/Licensed by VAGA, New York, NY. © 2016. Digital Image, The Museum of Modern Art, New York/Scala, Florence.

Finding New Forms (3 of 3)

- Rauschenberg, Cage, and Black Mountain College
 - John Cage explored eliminating intention and personal taste in art making; his 4'33" composition is an exercise in listening to silence.
 - Sometimes called the first "Happening," Theater Piece No. 1 was performed at Black Mountain College in 1952.

New Forms Abroad (1 of 2)

- Artists around the world began to experiment with performance and interactive exhibitions.
- Yves Klein directed nude women to become "living brushes" in *Anthropométries of the Blue Period* in 1960.



Yves Klein ANTHROPOMÉTRIES OF THE BLUE PERIOD

1960. Performance at the Galerie Internationale d'Art Contemporain, Paris.

© Yves Klein/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York/ADAGP, Paris 2016. Photo: Shunk - Kender @ J Paul Getty Trust.
Getty Research Institute, LA. (2014.R.20).

New Forms Abroad (2 of 2)

- Yoshihara Jirō founded the Gutai group in Japan, which produced dramatic performances
 - Shozo Shimamoto's *Hurling Colors* produced by smashing bottles of paint against a canvas on the floor.



Shozo Shimamoto HURLING COLORS
1956. Happening at the second Gutai Exhibition, Tokyo. Courtesy of Shozo Shimamoto.

Happenings and Fluxus (1 of 2)

- Allan Kaprow created loosely scripted, multimedia **Happenings**.
- Without the influence of Jackson Pollock's action paintings, **performance art** would not have been developed.

Happenings and Fluxus (2 of 2)

- Kaprow
 - Allan Kaprow staged *Yard* in a walled garden space filled with tires, tar paper, and barrels.
 - The audience was asked to walk through the cluttered, unfamiliar space.
 - *Meat Joy* was a radical feminist performance where eight men and women undressed and rolled in raw meat



Allan Kaprow YARD
1961. View of tires in court of Martha Jackson Gallery, New York, 1961.
Photo: Ken Heyman.



Carolee Schneemann MEAT JOY

1964. Gelatin-silver print. A photograph by Tony Ray-Jones, taken in Judson Memorial Church in November 1964. © 2016 Carolee Schneemann/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York. © Tony Ray-Jones/National Media Museum/Science & Society Picture Library.

Happenings and Performance Art (1 of 4)

- Fluxus
 - Fluxus events were deliberately acted performances that often focused on ordinary behaviors and were presented as written "scores."
 - George Brecht created *Three Aqueous Events* as one of 69 cards to be performed by the reader.

THREE AQUEOUS EVENTS

- ice
- water
- steam

Summer, 1961

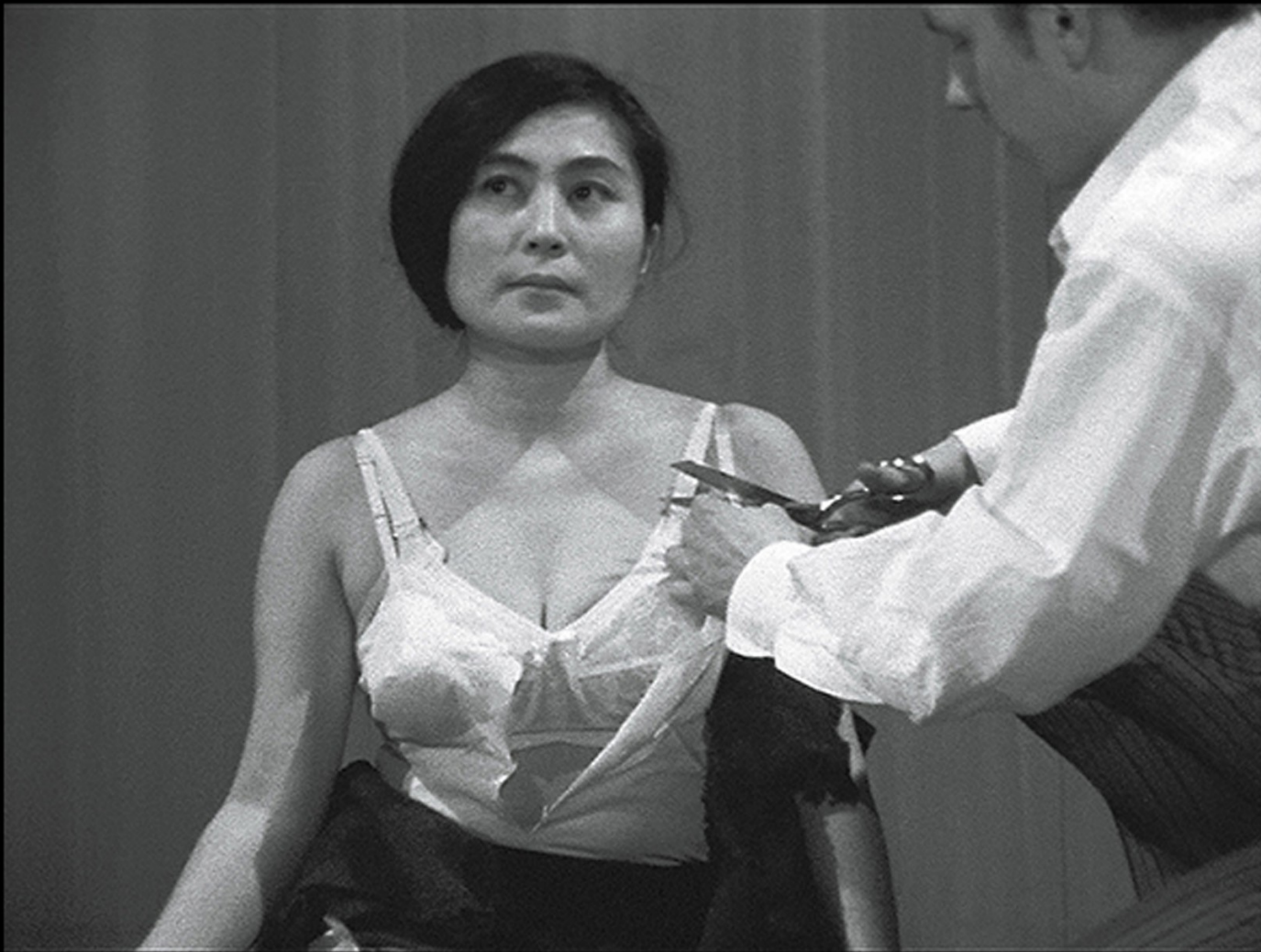


George Brecht THREE AQUEOUS EVENTS

1961. Event score from Water Yam edition, 1963. Performance view, Rutgers University, New Jersey, 1963. © 2016 Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York/VG Bild-Kunst, Bonn. Courtesy Walker Art Center. / © 2016 Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York/VG Bild-Kunst, Bonn. Photo: Peter Moore © Barbara Moore/Licensed by VAGA, New York, NY. Courtesy Paula Cooper Gallery, New York. © 2016 Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York/VG Bild-Kunst, Bonn.

Happenings and Performance Art (2 of 4)

- Fluxus
 - Yoko Ono's *Cut Piece* was first performed in Japan, then at Carnegie Hall.
 - Audience members were invited to cut away bits of her clothes to take with them.



Yoko Ono CUT PIECE
1965. Film still of performance at the Carnegie Recital Hall, New York on March 21, 1965.
Film by Albert and David Maysles.
© Yoko Ono.

Happenings and Performance Art (3 of 4)

- Fluxus
 - Korean artist Nam June Paik produced a number of works with Charlotte Moorman that combined sculpture, technology, music, and performance.
 - *TV Bra for Living Sculpture* was worn by Moorman while she played the cello.



Nam June Paik with Charlotte Moorman TV BRA FOR LIVING SCULPTURE
1969. Performance view. Gelatin silver print. Collection Walker Art Center. Minneapolis, T.B.Walker Acquisition Fund,
1991. Photograph by Peter Moore.
© Barbara Moore/Licensed by VAGA, New York, NY. Courtesy Paula Cooper Gallery, New York.

Happenings and Performance Art (4 of 4)

- Fluxus
 - Joseph Beuys created a repertoire of significant materials and objects that he used symbolically and performatively in his art in an attempt to explain the inexplicable.
 - *How to Explain Pictures to a Dead Hare* highlighted the problems inherent in normal communication.



Joseph Beuys HOW TO EXPLAIN PICTURES TO A DEAD HARE
1965. Photograph of performance at the Schmela Gallery, Dusseldorf, November 26, 1965. © Ute Klopheus © 2016
Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York/VG Bild-Kunst, Bonn. Courtesy Ronald Feldman Fine Arts, NY.

Pop Art (1 of 6)

- The growing presence of the mass media and disposable income fueled the origins of pop art in Britain, which was then developed in the early 1960s in the United States.
- Artists critiqued the superficiality of the fictional perfect home and perfect person.

Pop Art (2 of 6)

- Hamilton
 - Richard Hamilton's collage ...*Today's Homes...* satirizes modern life and materialism in marketing campaigns.
 - The piece represents two nearly naked people named Adam and Eve who fill their home with all the best products to "recreate" a Garden of Eden.



Richard Hamilton JUST WHAT IS IT THAT MAKES TODAY'S HOMES SO DIFFERENT, SO APPEALING?
 1956. Collage, 10-1/4" x 9-3/4" (26 x 24.7 cm).
 Kunsthalle Tübingen, Collection Zündel. © R. Hamilton. All Rights Reserved, DACS and ARS 2016.

Pop Art (3 of 6)

- Warhol and Lichtenstein
 - Andy Warhol dominated the Pop art scene from the 1960s onward.
 - *The Marilyn Diptych* was made after Monroe's apparent suicide, rendering her features flatly and recalling religious art.



Andy Warhol MARILYN DIPTYCH

1962. Oil, acrylic, and silkscreen on enamel on canvas, two panels,
each 6'10" x 4'9" (2.05 x 1.44 m).

Tate, London. Marilyn Monroe LLC under license authorized by CMG Worldwide Inc., Indianapolis, In © 2016 The Andy Warhol Foundation for
the Visual Arts, Inc./Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York. © Tate, London 2016

Pop Art (4 of 6)

- Warhol and Lichtenstein
 - Warhol exploited the lie that the mass media brings us closer to the world and emphasized that viewers can only observe it as detached voyeurs.

Pop Art (5 of 6)

- Warhol and Lichtenstein
 - His immense body of work included the Brillo boxes, Campbell Soup cans, and Coca-Cola bottles in the print method of **silkscreen**.
 - The Brillo boxes transformed the gallery space into what looked like a grocery stock room.



Andy Warhol BRILLO SOAP PADS BOX
1964. Silkscreen print on painted wood, 17" x 17" x 14" (43.2 x 43.2 x 35.6 cm).
Collection of The Andy Warhol Museum, Pittsburgh. © 2016 The Andy Warhol Foundation for the Visual Arts,
Inc./Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York.

Pop Art (6 of 6)

- Warhol and Lichtenstein
 - Roy Lichtenstein based his art on cartoon imagery, using **Benday dots** from offset printing.
 - Rather than a copy, *Oh, Jeff... I Love You, Too... But...* is formally adjusted and tightened, pitting an overblown episode into a work of high art.



Roy Lichtenstein OH, JEFF... I LOVE YOU, TOO... BUT...
1964. Oil and magna on canvas, 48" x 48" (122 x 122 cm).
Private collection. © Estate of Roy Lichtenstein/DACS 2016.

Minimalism (1 of 3)

- Previously called ABC Art or Primary Structures, minimalist art began for the purpose of dematerializing the art object.
- Slab-like sculptures rejected the gesture and emotion invested in handcrafted objects and traditional sculpting material.

Minimalism (2 of 3)

- Judd
 - Sculptor Donald Judd turned to Minimalism, which reduced artworks to technical essentials.
 - He evolved a formal vocabulary reduced to identical rectangular units, constructed of industrial materials, that were arranged in rows.



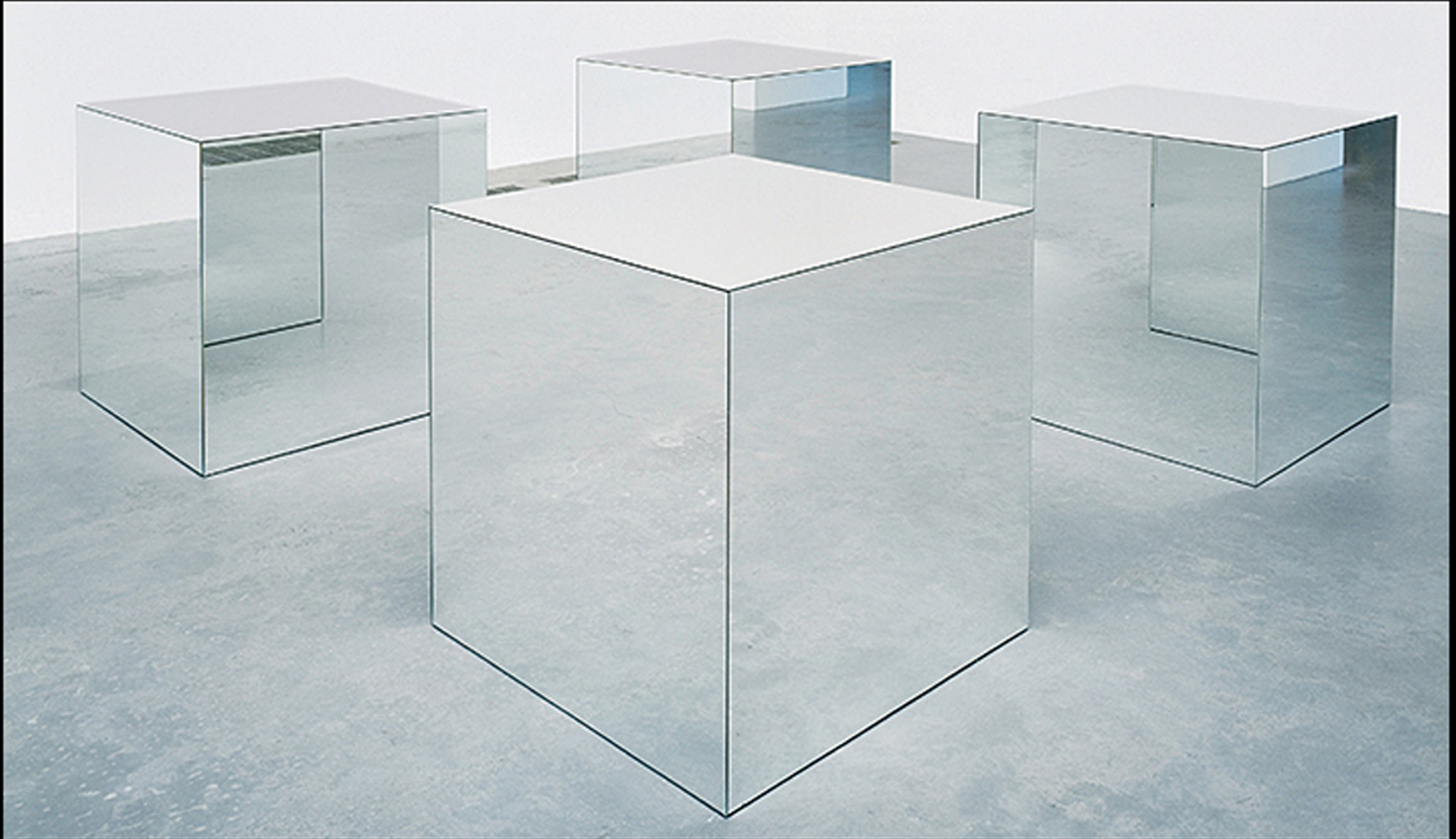
Donald Judd UNTITLED

1969. Galvanized iron and Plexiglas, 10 units, each 6" x 27-1/8" x 24"
(15.24 x 68.8 x 60.96 cm), overall 120" x 27-1/8" x 24" (3.05 x 0.69 x 0.61 m).

Albright-Knox Art Gallery, Buffalo, New York. Art © Judd Foundation. Licensed by VAGA, New York, NY. Photo © 2016. Albright Knox Art
Gallery/Art Resource, NY/Scala, Florence.

Minimalism (3 of 3)

- Morris
 - Four wooden cubes of industrial mirror glass deflect the viewer's eyes from finding any interest in the object itself in Morris's work *Untitled (Mirror Cube)*.
 - The interest of this piece lies entirely in its concept, which is interrogating the purposes and goals of the artist.



Robert Morris UNTITLED (MIRROR CUBES)
1965–1971. Mirror, plate glass, and wood, 36" × 36" × 36" (91.4 × 91.4 × 91.4 cm).
Tate, London. © 2016 Robert Morris/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York. © Tate, London 2016.

The Dematerialization of Art

- From the mid-1960s to the early 1970s, the youth of Europe and America led civil rights movements, protests against the Vietnam War, and environmentalist and feminist movements.
- There was a shift toward noncommodifiable and "dematerialized" art.

Conceptual Art and Language (1 of 2)

- Conceptual artists concluded that a performance or a conceptual manifestation (sometimes in the form of instructions) qualifies as art.
- Conceptual works of art usually leave behind some visual trace, but no object for purpose.
 - Some museums now collect those "trace" objects.

Conceptual Art and Language (2 of 2)

- Joseph Kosuth (b. 1945) abandoned painting to examine the conceptual intersection of language and vision.
 - His early work was indebted to the linguistic philosophy of Ludwig Wittgenstein.
 - *One and Three Chairs* presents an actual chair, a photograph of a chair, and the dictionary definition of "chair."



Joseph Kosuth ONE AND THREE CHAIRS

1965. Wooden folding chair, photograph of chair, and photographic enlargement of dictionary definition of chair; chair, 32-3/8" x 14-7/8" x 20-7/8" (82.2 x 37.8 x 53 cm), photo panel, 36" x 24-1/8" (91.4 x 61.3 cm), text panel 24-1/8" x 24-1/2" (61.3 x 62.2 cm). Museum of Modern Art, New York. Larry Aldrich Foundation Fund (383.1970 a-c). © 2016 Joseph Kosuth/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York. © 2016. Digital image, The Museum of Modern Art/Scala, Florence.

New Media (1 of 4)

- Nauman
 - Bruce Nauman created 11 color photographs based on wordplay and visual puns.
 - *Self-Portrait as a Fountain* designates the artist as a work of art recalling Duchamp's famous urinal; it abstracts the very idea of what a fountain could be.



Bruce Nauman SELF-PORTRAIT AS A FOUNTAIN
1966–1967. Color photograph, 19-3/4" x 23-3/4" (50.1 x 60.3 cm).
Courtesy Leo Castelli Gallery, New York. Photo: Eric Pollitzer. © 2016 Bruce Nauman/Artists Rights Society (ARS),
New York

New Media (2 of 4)

- One of Laurie Anderson's earliest performances was *Duets on Ice*, which involved her telling personal stories alternated with playing violin while wearing ice skates frozen in blocks of ice; the performance continued until the ice melted enough to release the blades.



Laurie Anderson DUETS ON ICE
1974. Photograph of a performance in New York, 1975.
Courtesy the artist. Photo: Bob Bielecki.

New Media (3 of 4)

- Viola and Paik
 - Video artist Bill Viola created the double projection of *The Crossing*.
 - One man slowly walks a great distance toward the camera, where a rainy deluge washes him away.
 - The other man is similarly and slowly engulfed by flames.
 - There is only one soundtrack to inform viewers' perception.



Bill Viola THE CROSSING

1996. Two channels of color video projections from opposite sides of a large dark gallery onto two back-to-back screens suspended from the ceiling and mounted on the floor; four channels of amplified stereo sound, four speakers. Height 16' (4.88 m). Courtesy Bill Viola Studio LLC. Performer: Phil Esposito. Photo: Kira Perov.

New Media (4 of 4)

- Viola and Paik
 - Korean-born Nam June Paik worked with modified television sets.
 - *Electronic Superhighway: Continental U.S.* was an ensemble of such televisions featuring a neon-outlined map of the continental United States.



Nam June Paik ELECTRONIC SUPERHIGHWAY: CONTINENTAL U.S.

1995. Forty-seven-channel closed-circuit video installation with 313 monitors, neon, steel structure, color, and sound, approx. 15' x 32' x 4' (4.57 x 9.75 x 1.2 m).

Smithsonian American Art Museum, Washington, DC. Gift of the artist. © Estate of Nam June Paik. Gift of the artist. Photograph © 2016 Photo Smithsonian American Art Museum/Art Resource/Scala.

Process and Materials (1 of 3)

- The reductivist approaches to Minimalism and Conceptualism had boxed art into an absolutist corner.
- Artists who refused to eliminate personal meaning from their works explored physicality, personality, and sensuality within the process of making art.

Process and Materials (2 of 3)

- Eva Hesse utilized personal history in her Minimalist creations.
- *No Title* takes on a different shape and size each time it is installed.
 - It consists of sections of rope dipped in latex, knotted, and hung from wires attached to the ceiling.



Eva Hesse NO TITLE

1969–1970. Latex over rope, string, and wire; two strands, dimensions variable.

Whitney Museum of American Art, New York. Purchase, with funds from Eli and Edythe L. Broad, the Mrs. Percy Uris Purchase Fund, and the Painting and Sculpture Committee (88.17 a-b). © The Estate of Eva Hesse. Hauser & Wirth. Whitney Museum of American Art, New York.

Photo: Geoffrey Clement.

Process and Materials (3 of 3)

- Arte Povera
 - This term encompasses art that incorporates ordinary, everyday materials as well as the Italian artists who practiced it.
 - *Pink-Blue-Pink* by Gilberto Zorio is an industrial pipe that was filled with cobalt chloride paste that, when subjected to changes in humidity, may vary in color across its segments.



Gilberto Zorio PINK-BLUE-PINK
1967. Semicylinder filled with cobalt chloride,
11- $\frac{7}{8}$ " x 112- $\frac{1}{4}$ " x 6" (30 x 285 x 15 cm).

Galleria Civic D'Arte Moderna e Contemporanea, Torino, Italy. Purchased by the Fondazione Guido ed Ettore De Fornaris from Pier Luigi Pero, Turin, 1985. © 2016 Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York/SIAE, Rome. Photo: Fotografico Studio Gonella, 2006.

Earthworks (1 of 3)

- Sculptors working outdoors used materials found at sites to fashion **earthworks**.
- Some of these works were available for a limited audience based on their remote location, while others were public.

Earthworks (2 of 3)

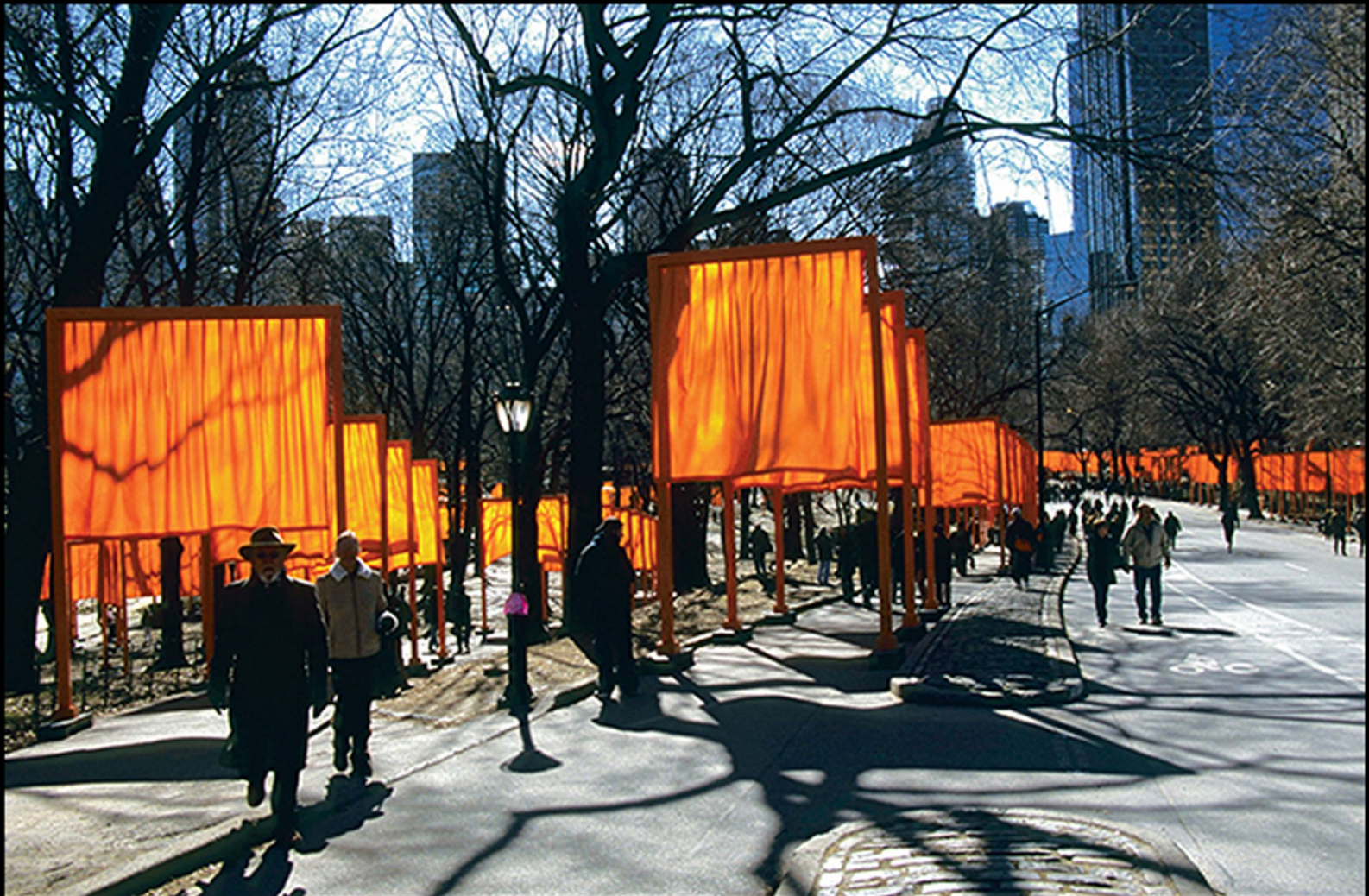
- Robert Smithson's *Spiral Jetty* illustrated the "ongoing dialectic" between constructive and destructive forces of nature.
 - He hoped the algae living in the Great Salt Lake would cause it to erode and disappear.
 - It is now covered with crystallized salt and can be seen on Google Earth.



Robert Smithson SPIRAL JETTY
1969–1970. Mud, precipitated salt crystals, rocks, and water.
Great Salt Lake, Utah. Photo Gianfranco Gorgoni. Courtesy James Cohan Gallery, New York. Art © Holt-Smithson
Foundation/Licensed by VAGA, New York, NY.

Earthworks (3 of 3)

- Christo and Jeanne-Claude created site-specific sculptures.
 - *The Gates, Central Park, New York, 1979–2005* consisted of a 23 mile installation of 7,503 saffron-colored nylon panels and lasted for only 16 days.
 - It took 26 years to realize.



Christo and Jeanne-Claude THE GATES, CENTRAL PARK, NEW YORK, 1979–2005.
1979–2005. Shown here during its installation in 2005.
© 2016 Christo and Jeanne-Claude. Photo: Wolfgang Volz.

Feminist Art (1 of 2)

- Feminists challenged the idea that great art was made by men.
 - Women were rarely mentioned in art history despite their contributions; when they were, their achievements were labeled as "crafts" as opposed to "fine arts."
- Second-wave feminist art defined gender in relativist terms.

Feminist Art (2 of 2)

- Third-wave feminist art emerged in the 1990s and addressed an expanded range of issues.
 - Artists explored discrimination inherent in gender and class, race, violence, postcolonialism, and transgenderism.

Chicago and Schapiro (1 of 4)

- Miriam Schapiro and Judy Chicago established the Feminist Art Program at the California Institute of the Arts.
- Schapiro believed in an explicitly feminine aesthetic, exhibited in her *Personal Appearance #3*.
 - She called the technique *fem mage*.
 - Formal and emotional richness was meant to counter male aesthetic.



Miriam Schapiro PERSONAL APPEARANCE #3
1973. Acrylic and fabric on canvas, 60" x 50" (152.4 x 127 cm).
Private collection. Photo: Robert Hickerson.

Chicago and Schapiro (2 of 4)

- Judy Chicago's *The Dinner Party* is a complex, mixed-media installation filling an entire room with proclamations of the accomplishments of women throughout history.
 - A large, triangular table displays place settings with 13 notable women on each side.
 - China painting and needlework draw on the tradition of women crafters.



Judy Chicago THE DINNER PARTY

1974–1979. Overall installation view. White tile floor inscribed in gold with 999 women's names; triangular table with painted porcelain, sculpted porcelain plates, and needlework, each side 48' x 42' x 3' (14.6 x 12.8 x 1 m). Brooklyn Museum of Art, New York. Gift of the Elizabeth A. Sackler Foundation (2002.10). Photo ©Donald Woodman/Through the Flower. © 2016 Judy Chicago/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York.



Judy Chicago THE DINNER PARTY
Georgia O'Keeffe place setting, detail of *The Dinner Party*.
Photo ©Donald Woodman/Through the Flower. © 2016 Judy Chicago/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York.

Chicago and Schapiro (3 of 4)

- Ana Mendieta
 - Cuba-born Ana Mendieta produced over 200 body works in which she "planted" herself in the earth and filmed her performances.
 - Her works celebrate the notion that women have a deeper identification than men with nature.



Ana Mendieta UNTITLED, FROM THE TREE OF LIFE SERIES
1977. Color photograph, 20" × 13-1/4" (50.8 × 33.7 cm).
© Estate of Ana Mendieta Collectio, LLC. Courtesy Galerie Lelong, New York.

Chicago and Schapiro (4 of 4)

- Mary Kelly
 - *Post-Partum Document* tracks the artist's relationship with her son for six years after his birth.
 - It incorporates Marxism, feminist philosophy, and psychoanalytic theory across its 135 objects, serving both as a work of art and a record of her son's most notable moments.

